

FIONA COHEN

SENIOR PRODUCT DESIGNER · COMPLEX SYSTEMS · DATA & AI PRODUCTS

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EXPERIENCE

GUIDEHOUSE

Senior UX Consultant | 2023–2026

UX Consultant | 2020–2023

2020–2026

Go-to product design expert across the practice, trusted to lead complex engagements, advise teams on product strategy, mentor **3 designers**, and present complex product and technical ideas clearly and persuasively to audiences ranging from engineers to executive leadership. Worked across the engagement lifecycle—from requests for proposals and executive pitches through research, product design, implementation, and quality assurance—contributing to **\$2M+ in new contracts in 2023**.

SOUND TRANSIT

Digital Accessibility Audit & Remediation Strategy

Accessibility Lead

2025

- Inherited an accessibility program stalled after a prior audit produced thousands of Jira tickets with no actionable path to remediation. Reframed the effort around systemic impact, reducing a **7,000+ page** site to the **160 highest-traffic pages and 29 shared templates** needed for meaningful coverage.
- Built four reusable applications for audit collection, aggregation, deduplication, and analytics, turning thousands of findings into structured data for identifying systemic issues and prioritizing remediation.
- Built a repeatable manual accessibility testing system by automating routine checks, defining clear testing protocols, and creating a workflow a team member could execute consistently under my direction.
- Developed a three-phase strategy—shared components, templates, then isolated issues—directing engineering toward fixes with the greatest system-wide impact.
- Brought client and engineering teams around a shared approach, then transferred the tooling, documentation, and training needed to continue remediation independently.

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF JUSTICE — OFFICE OF THE CHIEF INFORMATION OFFICER

2023–2025

Enterprise Employee Services Platform & Design System

Design Lead

- Established the Office of the Chief Information Officer's product design foundation: shared components, interaction patterns, accessibility standards, and implementation guidance for applications, websites, and internal tools.
- Created a common design language across product and engineering while accommodating the independent technical environments of domain-separated DOJ organizations.
- Architected the foundation for reuse, enabling teams to clone and adapt it to independent products rather than repeatedly starting from scratch.
- Presented design direction and recommendations directly to Department of Justice executive leadership, including the Chief Information Officer, communicating complex product and technical decisions at the executive level.
- Applied the system as design lead for **Time to Hire**, simplifying a complex HR process through integrations, intelligent fields, and automated document generation while partnering with engineering through implementation and QA.

DOJ Special Commendation — Excellence in Product Work

SELECTED GUIDEHOUSE WORK

CDC

2021

Digital Product & Data Modernization Initiatives

Design Lead

OneLab REACH
Shaped a live continuing-education experience for medical and public health professionals earning P.A.C.E. credits. Built its design system and reusable component library, prototyped and tested core workflows, and partnered through development.

CFA Evaluation
Evaluated site architecture and developed streamlined, reusable components and templates aligned to CDC standards.

Data Modernization Initiative
Created branded proof-of-concept websites and flexible modern UI patterns for a high-profile data modernization effort.

OneLab REACH Development Recommendation
Researched the development process and delivered a formal recommendation for a hybrid design/development approach.

Strong research and product work deepened the firm's relationship with CDC, resulting in continued work across multiple initiatives.

CONFIDENTIAL CLIENT

2020–2021

Specialized Parts Production Tracking Software

UX Lead

Directed UX across interconnected production applications, replacing cross-product inconsistencies with shared workflows and reusable patterns. Strengthened design-to-development QA with engineering, contributing to **~70% fewer post-release defects**.

MERCK

2020–2021

Geospatial Analytics Platform

Product Designer

Translated user feedback and geospatial visualization research into clearer ways to explore complex map-based data, establishing reusable UI and visualization standards. **Merck returned for additional design work based on the strength of the engagement.**

JPMORGAN CHASE
Disaster Management Analytics Platform

2021-2023
Design Lead

- Set product and design direction for JPMorgan Chase's disaster management reporting and analytics platform across incident monitoring, impact assessment, comparative analysis, reporting, and executive decision-making.
- Managed two designers, setting direction, delegating ownership, and raising team quality through ongoing critique while coordinating decisions across client stakeholders and engineering.
- Created a shared information architecture for complex operational data, translating it into role-specific workflows and visualizations for disaster specialists, analysts, and executives.
- Owned design through implementation and QA across 400+ high-fidelity screens as the engagement grew from one to four consultants and generated \$1.16M in additional work.

YAFFED
Design Lead & Developer

2019

Led the redesign and development of YAFFED's website end to end, restructuring the experience around core advocacy goals including petitions, donations, newsletter signups, and content discovery. Unified conversion paths and calls to action, then built the final responsive product in HTML/CSS.

TAMPA GENERAL HOSPITAL 2020-2021

Patient Billing & Financial Experience Product Designer & Researcher
Conducted user interviews plus qualitative and quantitative analysis to understand and improve patients' experience of finance and billing. Synthesized findings into product and service recommendations, created and led trainings for Tampa General Hospital teams, and presented findings and recommendations directly to Tampa General Hospital's Chief Executive Officer.

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF VETERANS AFFAIRS 2020-2021

Digital Healthcare & Emerging Technology Initiatives Product Designer
Healthcare Access Experience Concept
Created an Art of the Possible concept for improving access to VA healthcare.
Generative AI Facility Planning Tool
Also contributed to an early AI-assisted facility-planning tool that generated preliminary blueprints and floorplans for new VA centers from input criteria.

EDUCATION
Maryland Institute College of Art (MICA)
B.F.A., Graphic Design
Stuyvesant High School
New York, NY

EXPERTISE
Product Strategy · Complex Systems · Data Visualization · Design Systems · Accessibility · Research & Testing · Design Leadership · Information Architecture